



Across

- 4 Word that precedes *many long twos* by analytic-minded basketball heads, or *soon*, *late*, and *close for comfort* by casuals. (3)
- 6 The Shamm____, one of the most celebrated and lethal crossovers, was invented by this player and coach whose name features this answer twice. (3)
- 8 Sour metaphor popularized by Boman Jones, referring to a player or team *puckering* under pressure and *stinking* up the *tail end* of the game. (10)
- 12 Brown serving as the Rockets CEO. (3)
- 13 Affectionate nickname for the legendary Knicks bruiser who has been treated less

than affectionately by James Dolan in recent years. (3)

Down

- 1 "Oh, I didn't know that until now." - Internet user's abbreviation for discovering something new in the last 24 hours. (3)
- 2 Last name of Blazers wing out with a torn Achilles, or slang for the area you come from. (4)
- 3 Quinn or Daequan by last name, or Serge Ibaka by hobby. (4)
- 4 Nickname for the best Tracy in NBA history, third cousin of the best Vince in NBA history. (4)
- 5 ____/Off stats compare how a team fares when a player is in and out of the lineup.

(2)

- 6 Jordan. Or James. Or Wilt. Or Kareem. Or... debating this animal status could (and does) go on forever. (4)
- 7 Initials for the best blog covering OKC (we might be biased). (2)
- 9 Abbreviation for the kind of other-worldly creature that some of the NBA's most athletic players are said to be. (2)
- 10 In sentence case, Charles Outlaw's nickname. In uppercase, what might emanate from a player post-game and pre-shower. (2)
- 11 The currency Jeff Ayres gets paid with as a player in the B.League. (3)